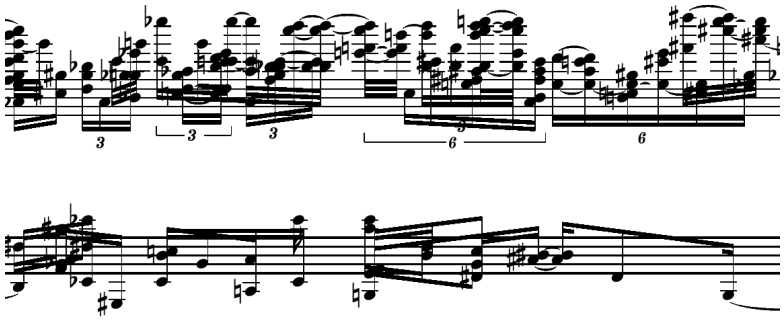
pop song

for piano & electronic tape

MAC WATERS



notes

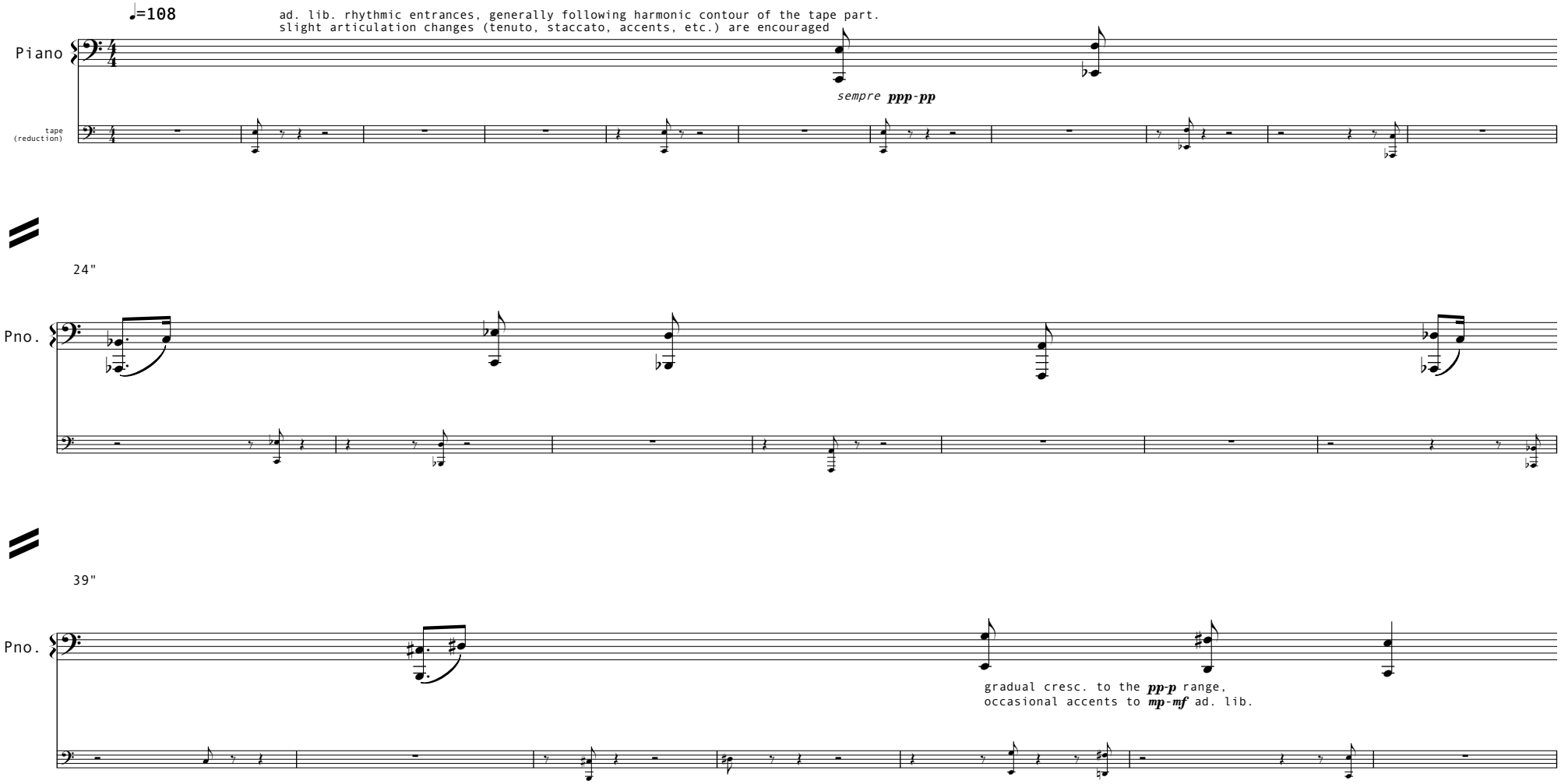
pop song, a piece I composed for the New Music on the Point Festival in June 2022 for pianist Conrad Tao, is inspired by the visceral energy of the eight-bar chord progression that is so often shied away from by composers of concert music. an infectious and ever-danceable chorus becomes the basis of guided improvisation, building over the course of four minutes from a fragmented soundscape—the shadow of what is to come—into an undeniably epic and seemingly endless rave. complementing the pianist is an onslaught of MIDI files and phantom piano recordings, bouncing around the stereo field and building to a new-complexity-like cacophony that harkens back to the Black MIDI YouTube craze of the early 2010's. The pianist should feel free to improvise with/in this simple chord progression where needed, especially as the recording builds, and is encouraged to be completely virtuosic in their interpretation of the notated passages, most of which serve as improvisational guides. Most importantly, though, the piece is a dance party—let loose!

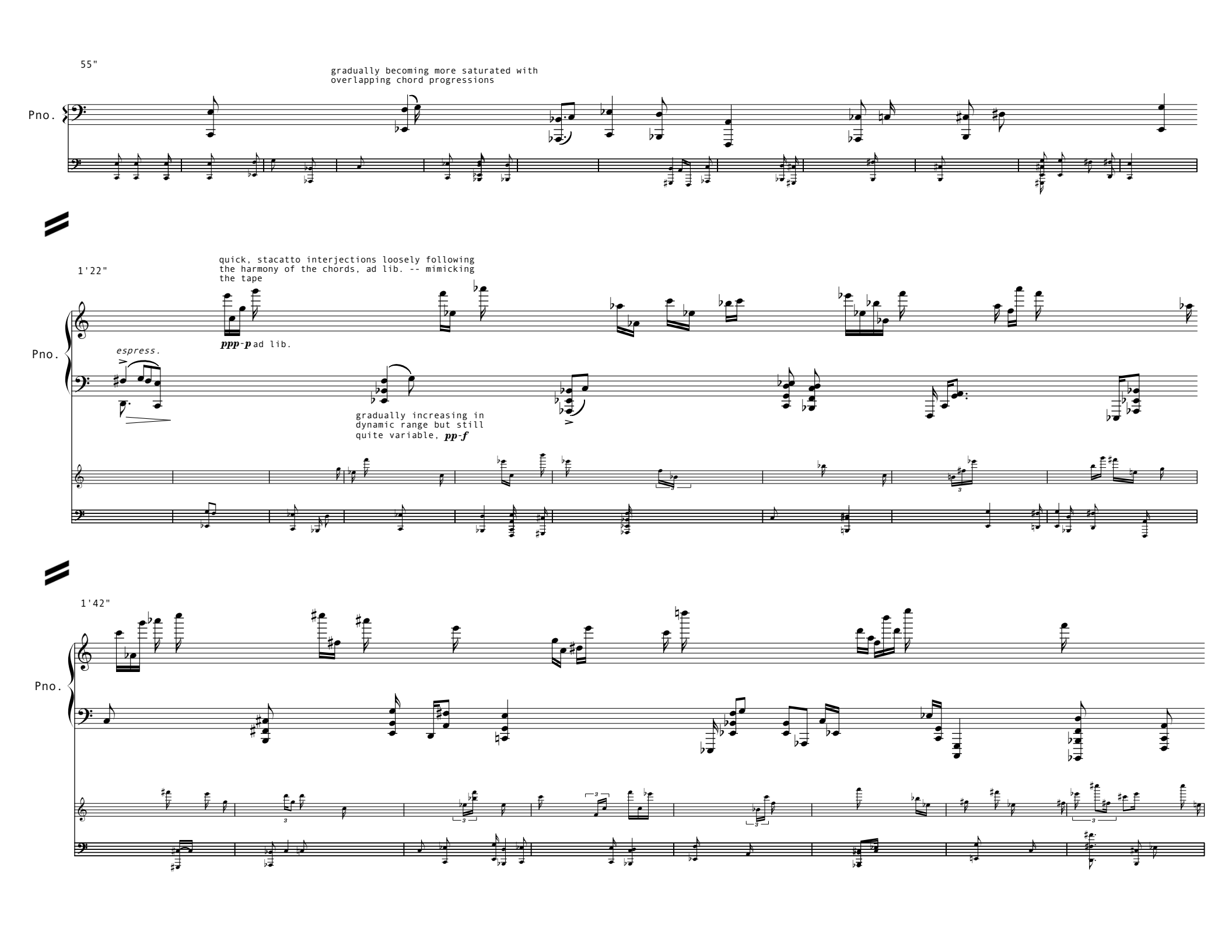
pop song

for piano & electronic tape

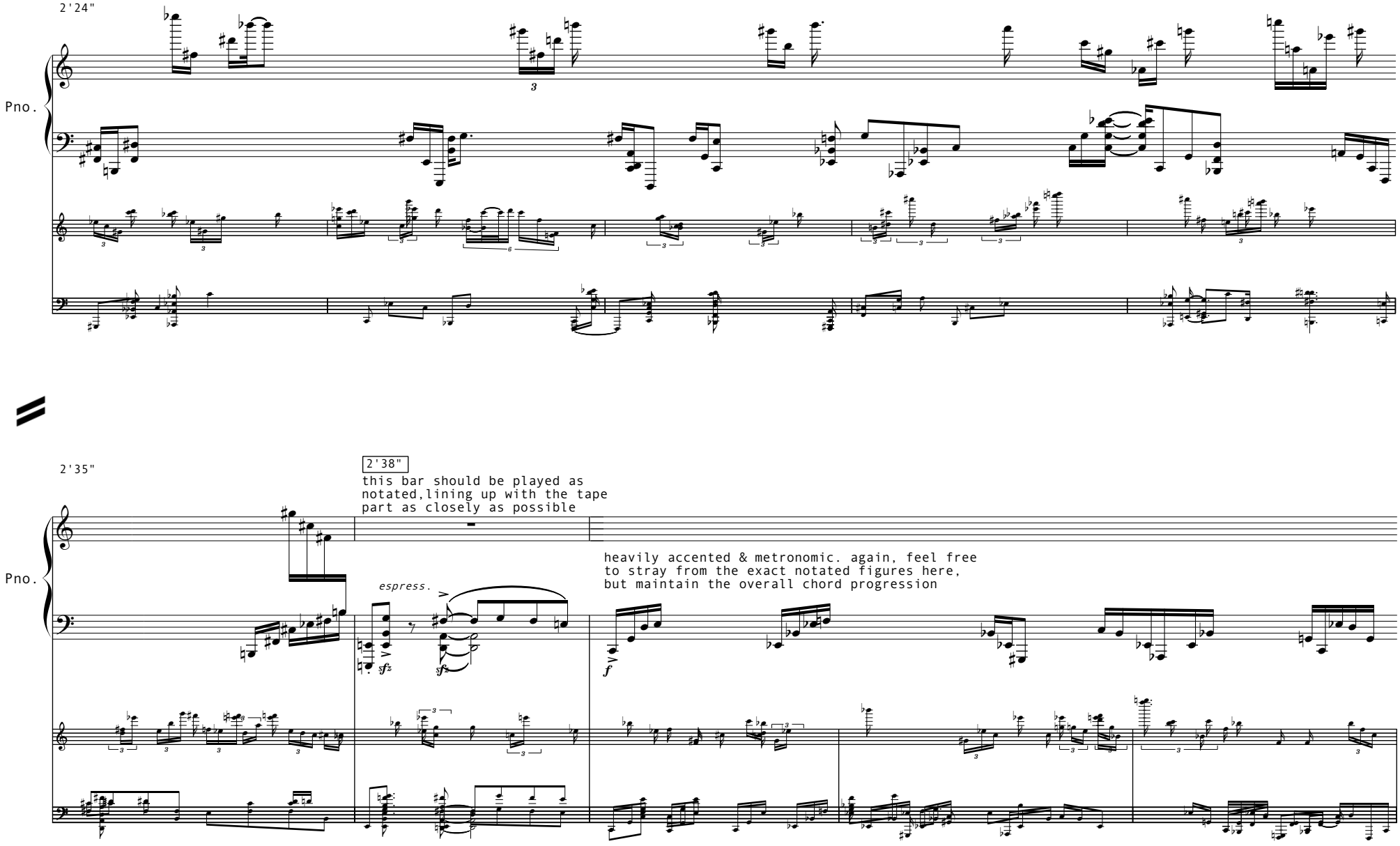
composed for Conrad Tao, New Music on the Point 2022

MAC WATERS




55"
gradually becoming more saturated with
overlapping chord progressions
Pno.
1'22"
quick, stacatto interjections loosely following
the harmony of the chords, ad lib. -- mimicking
the tape
ppp-p ad lib.
espress.
Pno.
gradually increasing in
dynamic range but still
quite variable, pp-f
1'42"
Pno.


1'59"
Pno.
at this point, feel free to move beyond these notated figures, improvising any sort of similar material within the general contour of the chord progression
now in the mp-f range
2'13"
Pno.


2'24"
Pno.
2'35"
2'38"
this bar should be played as
notated,lining up with the tape
part as closely as possible
espress.
heavily accented & metronomic. again, feel free
to stray from the exact notated figures here,
but maintain the overall chord progression
Pno.

2'46"

gradually become more raucous,adding
clusters & more non-chordal notes

Pno.

2'57"

Pno.

3'08"

Pno.

3'19"

Pno.

3'46"
3'28"

Pno.

ff

3'59"
3'42"

Pno.

6

mf cresc.

4'11"

lose your shit! (wrong notes/clusters encouraged)

Pno.

ff

fff

4'23"

Pno.

4'34"



new york, may 2022